

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 179 · HOT

Nebius Group

AI Cloud · GPU Compute Infrastructure · Amsterdam · Nasdaq: NBIS (\$2B Nvidia investment, Mar 2026)

Nebius Group, the Amsterdam-headquartered, Nasdaq-listed AI cloud that Nvidia backed with \$2B in March, reported first-quarter revenue of \$399M, up 684%, contracted power above 3.5 GW and a backlog past \$50B on 13 May 2026, and secured up to 1.2 GW for an owned AI factory in Pennsylvania.

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OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Audi Revolut F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Nebius reported on 13 May that first-quarter revenue reached \$399M, up 684% from \$50.9M a year earlier; contracted power passed 3.5 GW, year-end guidance rose above 4 GW, and up to 1.2 GW was secured for an owned AI factory in Pennsylvania. Behind it sits a backlog above \$50B, including a Microsoft agreement worth up to \$19.4B and a \$27B Meta agreement, plus Nvidia's \$2B equity investment of 11 March. On 24 June Nebius shipped AI Cloud 3.6 with Echo, a natural-language console agent: the cadence of a company selling to enterprises, not only labs.

The neocloud archetype is already priced on the grid: CoreWeave is Aston Martin Aramco's Official AI Cloud Computing Partner and Core Scientific sits on Cadillac's inaugural roster, while Oracle is Red Bull's title partner and Microsoft sits at Mercedes and Alpine. Nebius is the European in the group, headquartered in Amsterdam with sites in Finland, France, the UK and Iceland, and its home race, the final Dutch GP at Zandvoort, falls on 23 August.

WHY NOW

The Q1 print landed on 13 May and the Nvidia stake in March; brand budgets follow such quarters. The last Dutch GP at Zandvoort on 23 August is a one-time home stage for an Amsterdam company, eight weeks out, and teams close 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$2B

Public company (Nasdaq: NBIS); \$2B direct equity investment from Nvidia announced 11 Mar 2026

\$399M

Q1 2026 revenue \$399M, up 684% from \$50.9M a year earlier (13 May 2026)

\$50B

Behind it sits a backlog above \$50B, including a Microsoft agreement worth up to \$19.4B and a \$27B Meta agr...

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Audi F1 Team	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Scuderia Ferrari	TAKEN	HP, IBM
McLaren F1 Team	TAKEN	Dell Technologies, Google Cloud
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	CoreWeave, NetApp

BOTTOM LINE

\$399M of quarterly revenue up 684%, more than \$50B of contracted backlog and \$2B from Nvidia give Nebius the capacity and the motive; Audi's compute lane is empty and simulation-hungry, and the last Dutch GP on 23 August is a home stage that will not come again.

EARNINGS INFLECTION CATEGORY WHITESPACE HOME RACE DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY AUDI REVOLUT F1 TEAM

Audi is the newest works team, with the only F1 base in Germany: its power unit has been developed at Neuburg since 2022, where Audi says virtual simulation carries the programme because the new units could not run on track until 2026. Hewlett Packard Enterprise left the roster in the last twelve months and no cloud or GPU partner replaced it; Revolut holds the title, Extreme Networks the network lane. A European AI cloud with Finnish, French and UK sites answers a German manufacturer's data-residency rules.

VALUE TO AUDI REVOLUT F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. Neuburg's power-unit programme lives on simulation: combustion, energy-recovery and battery models, dyno correlation. Hinwil adds the aerodynamic and race-strategy load allowed outside the testing restrictions. Nebius supplies elastic GPU clusters with EU data residency, on demand, at the peaks. In return: Official AI Cloud Partner status, sidepod placement, Zandvoort and Austin hospitality for Nebius' enterprise buyers.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Cloud Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, the first full seasons of Audi's works programme. Estimated \$5-8M a year, part-payable in GPU capacity. Scope: sidepod placement, naming of the team's AI compute environment, Zandvoort and US-race hospitality, engineering content from Neuburg.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Arkady Volozh

FOUNDER & CEO, NEBIUS GROUP · **VERIFIED**

Volozh founded Yandex and has led Nebius since July 2024; he signs its largest commitments and its quarterly shareholder letters. Path: Marc Boroditsky, Chief Revenue Officer since May 2025; Daniel Bounds, Chief Marketing Officer; Dado Alonso, Chief Financial Officer since June 2025.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with Zandvoort and the empty Audi compute lane.

“Arkady, Nvidia put \$2B behind you and Microsoft and Meta put \$46B of contracts; the last Dutch GP is eight weeks away and Audi has no cloud partner. 25 minutes to see how a Zandvoort announcement would work?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 Q1 on 13 May; Zandvoort on 23 Aug inside the window.	CAPACITY 19 / 20 \$50B+ backlog; \$2B from Nvidia; Nasdaq-listed.	BRAND FIT 13 / 20 Developer-facing B2B brand; European sovereignty story.	URGENCY 13 / 20 Final Dutch GP is a one-time home stage; Q4 rosters.	OPS FIT 14 / 20 MODE A: GPU clusters for Neuburg simulation.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

VOLATILE EQUITY Nebius shares have swung by a quarter in a week; marketing budgets get cut when the tape turns. **Counter:** Take part of the fee in compute capacity, which Nebius has in surplus as sites come online.

MICROSOFT ADJACENCY Nebius' largest customer holds the cloud lane at Mercedes and Alpine; an Audi deal must not read as competing with a customer. **Counter:** Audi's lane is empty; Nebius sells capacity, not a hyperscaler brand, and Microsoft stays a customer.

SOURCES — 16 OF 16 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://nebius.com/newsroom/nebius-reports-first-quarter-2026-financial-results
- https://www.cnbc.com/2026/03/11/nebius-nvidia-ai-cloud.html
- https://www.fool.com/investing/2026/04/19/nebius-has-landed-46-billion-in-ai-cloud-deals-cou/
- https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20260513568820/en/Nebius-reports-first-quarter-2026-financial-results